ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE AA

Vote YES on AA **to repair aging La Mesa-Spring Valley schools WITHOUT INCREASING TAX RATES.**

Our children need safe and up-to-date classrooms — not leaky roofs, failing pipes, outdated electrical systems, and classrooms with temperatures above 90 degrees. While our schools are well maintained, most local schools were built **more than 60 years ago and need urgent repairs and upgrades.**

Voting YES on AA repairs and upgrades our elementary and middle schools WITHOUT INCREASING TAX RATES. Measure AA simply **extends the current tax rate** previously approved by voters **without an increase.**

This fiscally responsible plan upgrades our schools before the repairs become more expensive. Voting YES also helps our schools **qualify for up to $61,000,000 in state matching funds** that will otherwise go to schools in other communities. That's why **the San Diego County Taxpayers Association endorses Measure AA.**

Measure AA will:

- Repair deteriorating roofs, plumbing, sewer, electrical, and HVAC systems
- Protect students from extreme heat with air conditioning and shade structures
- Improve campus security with locks, cameras, emergency communications, smoke detectors, fire alarms, and sprinklers
- Remove hazardous materials like asbestos and lead pipes and improve access for students with disabilities
- Upgrade classrooms, labs, technology, and multipurpose rooms for math, science, reading, writing, arts, and music

Measure AA requires **strict fiscal accountability protections** to ensure all funds stay local and are spent as promised, including:

- A detailed project list and required public disclosure of all spending
- An independent oversight committee and annual audits
- All funds must be locally controlled and cannot be taken by the state or federal government
- No funds can be used for employee salaries or benefits

Whether or not you have school-age children, **strong schools protect home values, strengthen neighborhoods, and improve quality of life** for students, families, and the entire community.

Vote YES on AA **to repair aging schools WITHOUT INCREASING TAX RATES.**

DR. MARK ARAPOSTATHIS
Mayor of La Mesa, Retired LMSVSD Teacher, Lifelong La Mesa Resident

MARK KERSEY
President & CEO, San Diego County Taxpayers Association

CHRISTINA HICKS
PTA Council President & LMSVSD Parent

KATHY SHEETS
President, La Mesa-Spring Valley Teachers Association

AHMAD SWINTON
California School Employees Association Chapter President & LMSVSD Parent

No Argument Against Measure AA was filed with the Office of the Registrar of Voters

FULL TEXT OF MEASURE AA

The following is the full proposition presented to the voters by the La Mesa-Spring Valley School District (the "District"). In connection with this bond proposition, the Board of Education (the "Board") of the District has made the following findings:

FINDINGS

- The District provides quality education for more than 10,000 local students in preschool through eighth grade that prepares them for success in high school, college and future careers.
- With most local schools built more than 60 years ago, the District is working to ensure all students learn in classrooms that meet current educational standards as well as fire, earthquake, security and safety standards.
- Some schools were built so long ago that underground clay and cast-iron pipes and infrastructure are failing, resulting in gas leaks, water leaks and sewage backups.
- During warmer months, classroom temperatures can exceed 90 degrees, requiring air conditioning and outdoor shade structures to keep students cool and safe.
- A thorough assessment of each classroom and school facility has identified high-priority repairs and upgrades.
- The District has developed a thorough and comprehensive Facilities Master Plan to complete the highest priority repairs and upgrades needed at each school campus.
- Because the State does not provide dedicated funding to school districts for repairing and upgrading school facilities and bond measures are the primary means by which local school districts fund these needs, the Board believes that locally controlled funding from a school improvement bond measure is needed to repair and upgrade aging local schools.
- With an old bond measure set to expire, the District has an opportunity to issue new bonds by extending, but not increasing, the tax rate paid by local property owners.
- The proposed bond extension measure is not projected to increase tax rates beyond the amount local property owners currently pay.
- If approved by local voters, the extension measure would generate $131 million in locally controlled funding by extending the current bond tax rate previously approved by voters.
- Funding from the extension measure would be used to repair or replace deteriorating roofs, plumbing, sewer and electrical systems.
- Funds from the extension measure would also install shade structures and air conditioning to protect students from extreme heat.
- Funds from the extension measure would improve student safety and campus security, including security locks, emergency communications systems, security cameras, smoke detectors, fire alarms and sprinklers.
- Funds from the extension measure would upgrade classrooms, labs, technology and multipurpose rooms to support programs in math, science, reading, writing, arts and music.
- Funds from the extension measure would remove hazardous materials like asbestos and lead pipes from older schools, and upgrade older schools to meet current health codes, building safety codes and improve access for students with disabilities.
- Voter approval of the bond extension measure will help local schools qualify for an estimated $61 million in state matching funds that will otherwise will go to improve schools in other communities.

- The proposed school improvement bond extension measure includes mandatory local control and fiscal accountability requirements, including a detailed project list describing how funds must be spent.
- The proposed school improvement bond extension measure requires public disclosure of all spending, an independent oversight committee and annual audits.
- All funds from the extension measure would be locally controlled and cannot be taken by the state or federal government, funds may only be used for repairs and upgrades at local school campuses and cannot be diverted to other purposes.

SUMMARY OF THE BOND MEASURE

"**La Mesa Spring Valley School District Classroom Repair & Upgrade Extension Measure.** To repair/upgrade deteriorating roofs, plumbing, electrical systems; install air conditioning/shade structures to protect students from extreme heat; remove asbestos/lead pipes; and upgrade schools to current health/building safety/disability access standards, shall La Mesa Spring Valley School District's measure be adopted, authorizing $131,000,000 in bonds at legal rates (without increasing current tax rates), levying $22 per $100,000 assessed value ($9,000,000 annually) while bonds are outstanding, with independent oversight and audits?"

PROJECT LIST FOR THE BOND MEASURE

Bond proceeds will be expended to upgrade, repair, expand, modernize, replace, renovate, acquire, construct, furnish and equip facilities, including athletic facilities, of the District including the following types of projects at any of the District's schools and sites, including for the following purposes:

Improvements to Promote Student Health and Safety

- Retrofit older buildings with earthquake safety improvements
- Replace and/or repair aging roofs
- Replace and/or upgrade outdated sewer, stormwater, plumbing, electrical, HVAC and other utility related infrastructure
- Upgrade and/or replace school safety systems, fire alarms, sprinklers and smoke detectors
- Install and/or upgrade security fencing and systems
- Remove hazardous materials
- Upgrade or construct restrooms
- Perform Americans with Disabilities Act compliance upgrades to expand and create accessible paths of travel
- Improve safety of student pick-up and drop-off zones

Upgrade and Renovate Classrooms and other Facilities

- Construct new/renovate existing classrooms, student and staff restrooms, outdoor learning spaces and custodial rooms
- Upgrade classrooms, multi-purpose rooms, labs, and career-training and school facilities
- Modernize facilities
- Construct dedicated labs for science, technology, engineering, math, design and robotics
- Improve, modernize, furnish, and equip school sites and District support facilities, including related work areas, service areas, parking, equipment, utility connections, storage, safety systems, and infrastructure.

FULL TEXT OF MEASURE AA (CONTINUED)

Critical Infrastructure and Information Technology (IT) Enhancements

- Upgrade instructional technology
- Modernize IT/technology infrastructure, including wireless, servers, data archiving, backup and security systems
- Upgrade safety and security systems, including phone systems, communication systems, bell and clock systems, lighting and emergency communication systems

Upgraded Physical Education and Auditorium Facilities

- Construct, expand and/or replace existing physical education, athletic and auditorium facilities, including shade structures, playgrounds, gymnasiums, turf and fields
- Restore and/or upgrade locker rooms, bleachers, fields, courts, gym floor, playground asphalt surfaces and outdoor areas
- Renovate or upgrade multi-purpose rooms, child nutrition facilities, kitchens, shelters and server areas

Energy and Water Efficiency Improvements

- Install climate-appropriate landscaping and water-efficient irrigation systems
- Update turf in common areas, play areas, and athletic facilities to save water
- Replace outdated heating and cooling systems with more energy-efficient systems
- Make energy efficiency improvements such as installing efficient lighting, energy management systems, solar panels, batteries and electrical storage facilities, as needed to reduce utility costs
- Upgrade and improve building envelope systems, including roofs, windows, doors, glazing, insulation, exterior walls, weatherproofing, and related components, to improve energy efficiency, indoor comfort, and overall building performance

* * *

The Board may authorize the completion of listed projects at all of the schools, sites or buildings where the project is deemed necessary.

Listed projects, repairs, improvements, rehabilitation projects and upgrades will be completed only as needed, and the listing of projects does not imply a particular prioritization among such improvements. Projects may be done in phases, based on Board priorities. Decisions regarding the scope, timing, prioritization or other facets of project implementation will be made solely by the Board by subsequent action. Where terms such as "renovate," "upgrade," and "improve" are used in the Bond Project List, the Board has the discretion to determine the best method for accomplishing the project's objective. For any listed project involving renovation or modernization of a building or the major portion of a building, the District may proceed with new replacement construction instead (including any necessary demolition), if the District determines that replacement and new construction is more practical than renovation, considering the building's age, condition, expected remaining life, comparative cost and other relevant factors. In addition, where feasible, projects may be completed in partnership with other agencies on a joint-use basis using bond proceeds. Property, buildings and equipment listed on the Bond Project List may be acquired through lease, sale, lease purchase, lease-leaseback or other project delivery or acquisition methods determined appropriate by the Board.

Each project is assumed to include its share of costs of bond issuance, architectural, engineering, legal and similar planning costs, construction management, bond project staff and consultants, staff professional development associated with current best practices for planning, construction, commissioning, closeout, and transition of new bond-funded facilities, equipment, systems, technologies, and improvements, and a

customary contingency for unforeseen design and construction costs. Payment of the costs of preparation of facilities planning and project implementation studies, feasibility and assessment reviews, master planning, environmental studies, traffic studies, energy analysis, permit and inspection fees and temporary housing and relocation costs for dislocated programs or activities caused or necessitated by projects on the Bond Project List are permissible bond expenditures. All projects may be furnished and equipped using bond proceeds to ensure the functionality and usability of facilities and sites constructed or reconstructed with bond proceeds.

The final cost of each project will be determined as plans are finalized and projects are completed. Based on the final costs of each project, certain of the projects described above may be delayed or may not be completed. Necessary site preparation, grading or restoration may occur in connection with the acquisition of property, new construction, modernization, renovation or remodeling, or installation or removal of modular classrooms, including ingress and egress, removing, replacing or installing irrigation, utility lines, trees and landscaping, relocating fire access roads and acquiring any necessary easements, leases, licenses or rights of way to the property.

In preparing the list of projects, the District has evaluated safety, class size reduction, and informational technology needs.

FISCAL ACCOUNTABILITY: THIS MEASURE REQUIRES A CLEAR SYSTEM OF ACCOUNTABILITY, INCLUDING A PROJECT LIST DETAILING HOW THE MONEY WILL BE USED, AN INDEPENDENT CITIZENS' BOND OVERSIGHT COMMITTEE, AND INDEPENDENT AUDITS TO ENSURE MONEY IS SPENT PROPERLY.

IN ACCORDANCE WITH EDUCATION CODE SECTION 15272, THE BOARD WILL APPOINT A CITIZENS' OVERSIGHT COMMITTEE AND CONDUCT ANNUAL INDEPENDENT AUDITS TO ASSURE THAT FUNDS ARE SPENT ONLY ON DISTRICT PROJECTS AND FOR NO OTHER PURPOSE. THE EXPENDITURE OF BOND MONEY ON THESE PROJECTS IS SUBJECT TO STRINGENT FINANCIAL ACCOUNTABILITY REQUIREMENTS. BY LAW, PERFORMANCE AND FINANCIAL AUDITS WILL BE PERFORMED ANNUALLY, AND ALL BOND EXPENDITURES WILL BE MONITORED BY AN INDEPENDENT CITIZENS' OVERSIGHT COMMITTEE TO ENSURE THAT FUNDS ARE SPENT AS PROMISED AND SPECIFIED. THE CITIZENS' BOND OVERSIGHT COMMITTEE MUST INCLUDE, AMONG OTHERS, REPRESENTATION OF A BONA FIDE TAXPAYERS ASSOCIATION, A BUSINESS ORGANIZATION AND A SENIOR CITIZENS ORGANIZATION. NO DISTRICT EMPLOYEES OR VENDORS ARE ALLOWED TO SERVE ON THE CITIZENS' OVERSIGHT COMMITTEE.

NO ADMINISTRATOR SALARIES UNRELATED TO BOND PROGRAM: PROCEEDS FROM THE SALE OF THE BONDS AUTHORIZED BY THIS PROPOSITION SHALL BE USED ONLY FOR THE ACQUISITION, CONSTRUCTION, RECONSTRUCTION, REHABILITATION, OR REPLACEMENT OF DISTRICT FACILITIES, INCLUDING THE FURNISHING AND EQUIPPING OF SCHOOL FACILITIES, AND NOT FOR ANY OTHER PURPOSE, INCLUDING TEACHER AND SCHOOL ADMINISTRATOR SALARIES OTHER THAN THOSE DIRECTLY RELATED TO THE IMPLEMENTATION OF THE DISTRICT'S BOND PROGRAM.

NO PERSONAL TECHNOLOGY DEVICES: PROCEEDS OF THE BONDS SHALL NOT BE SPENT ON PERSONAL TECHNOLOGY DEVICES FOR TEACHERS, STAFF OR STUDENTS.

STATE MATCHING FUNDS. THE FOLLOWING STATEMENT IS INCLUDED IN THIS MEASURE PURSUANT TO EDUCATION CODE SECTION 15122.5: APPROVAL OF MEASURE AA DOES NOT GUARANTEE THAT THE PROPOSED PROJECT OR PROJECTS IN THE LA MESA-SPRING VALLEY SCHOOL DISTRICT THAT ARE THE SUBJECT OF BONDS UNDER MEASURE AA WILL BE FUNDED BEYOND THE LOCAL REVENUES GENERATED BY MEASURE AA. THE SCHOOL DISTRICT'S PROPOSAL FOR THE PROJECT OR PROJECTS MAY ASSUME THE RECEIPT OF MATCHING STATE FUNDS, WHICH COULD BE SUBJECT TO APPROPRIATION BY THE LEGISLATURE OR APPROVAL OF A STATEWIDE BOND MEASURE.